

6. Referencing and academic integrity

What is Academic Integrity?

- ☐ Expressing your ideas in your own words.
- ☐ Demonstrating your understanding and sharing your personal perspectives.
- ☐ Acknowledging others' work and contributions.
- ☐ Respect for others, yourself and your college.

What is Academic Integrity?

It is doing your own work AND when using the work of others giving appropriate credit/citations.

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Academic dishonesty or **academic misconduct** is cheating on any academic exercise.

Copying and pasting materials found on the Internet into papers is trivial, it seems like a huge waste of time not to do so.

Would you want to be operated on by a doctor who cheated his way through medical school ? Or would you feel comfortable on a bridge designed by an engineer who cheated her way through engineering school ? Would you trust your tax return to an accountant who copied his exam answers from his neighbor ?

1. Plagiarism

- ☐ The adoption or reproduction of ideas or words or statements of another person without due acknowledgment. Intentionally using another person's writing/academic work and submitting it as your own.
- ☐ Failing to correctly cite another person's writing/academic work.
- ☐ The submission of the same work for academic credit more than once without permission.

2. Falsification

- ☐ Falsifying an exam, paper, project, application, transcript or test using dishonest means or assisting another student to do so.

3. Unauthorized collaboration

- ☐ Using materials or collaborating with another person(s) during a test or other assignment without authorization.

4. Substitution

- ☐ Substituting for another student, or permitting another person to substitute for oneself during an exam, course, or on other work.

5. Cheating

- ☐ The acquisition of grades, academic credits, degrees, honors, awards, certification, or professional endorsements by means of cheating.

6. Failure to Comply

- ☐ Failing to comply with the policies of the student's program or department as stated in publications.

Plagiarism: A Crime by Any Name

Copying &
Pasting

Stealing

Academic
Dishonesty

Idea
Theft



"Borrowing"

Examples of Academic Misconduct

1. Buying, stealing or borrowing a paper.
2. Hiring or asking someone to complete coursework or take a test.
3. Copying from another source without citing (intentionally or by accident).
4. Cutting or pasting text or graphics from Internet sources without proper citation.
5. Using the source too closely when paraphrasing without proper citation.

SOURCE: www.library.dmacc.edu/PublicPages/Plagiarism.htm

Document the following sources:

- ☐ Summaries, paraphrases, or direct quotations from a source
- ☐ Reprints of diagrams, illustrations, charts or pictures
- ☐ Little-known facts
- ☐ Other people's opinions
- ☐ Results of other people's research (opinion polls, case studies, statistics)
- ☐ Quotations or paraphrases from people you interview

Documentation is not required:

- ☐ Common knowledge (facts that can be found in many places and are likely to be known – Ex. The sun rises in the east.)
- ☐ Your own ideas, opinions, or conclusions
- ☐ Your own research (Unless it is published)

Examples of Plagiarism

There are many forms of academic dishonesty, including plagiarism, or the representation of another person's words, ideas, or information as if they were your own. You may use another person's words, ideas, or information, but to do so without acknowledgment is plagiarism. Perhaps the most serious form of plagiarism is failure to acknowledge the source of a direct quotation or paraphrase. Whether accidental or deliberate, failure to acknowledge that you have borrowed another's language, ideas, or information constitutes plagiarism.

How to recognize plagiarism

Here is the original text from an article in the March 2004 issue of *Scientific American*:

Original: Over the past few million years the earth's climate has swung repeatedly between ice ages and warm interglacial periods. A 400,000-year record of temperature is preserved in the Antarctic ice sheet, which, except for coastal fringes, escaped melting even in the warmest interglacial periods. This record suggests that the present interglacial period (the Holocene), now about 12,000 years old, is already long of tooth. (Hansen 70)

Plagiarism Example 1:

According to Hansen, the record suggests that the present interglacial period (the Holocene), now about 12,000 years old, is already long of tooth (70).

- **Why is it plagiarism?** Even though the information source is documented, this is plagiarism because the writer didn't indicate that a phrase was borrowed word-for-word. To correct the problem, enclose the borrowed words in quotation marks.
- **Acceptable:** According to Hansen, the "record suggests that the present interglacial period (the Holocene), now about 12,000 years old, is already long of tooth" (70).

Plagiarism Example 2:

Over the past few millennia, the climate of the earth has swung back and forth between ice ages and warm periods. The record of temperature preserved in the Antarctic ice sheet suggests that our current warm period is already long in the tooth.

□ **Why is it plagiarism?** This is plagiarism because the writer has only changed a few words or phrases, and the writer has also failed to cite a source for any of the ideas or facts. Two acceptable texts, one using a paraphrase and the other using a combination of paraphrase and direct quotation, are shown below.

□ **Acceptable:** Studies of the Antarctic ice sheet show that earth's climate has cycled between ice ages and warm periods and back again over time, and that our current warm period has already lasted longer than usual (Hansen 70).

□ **Acceptable:** By studying the Antarctic ice sheet, scientists have determined that "the earth's climate has swung repeatedly between ice ages and warm interglacial periods" and that our current warm period has already lasted longer than usual (Hansen 70).

Example 3. Direct Plagiarism

Student Writer A:

Long ago, when there was no written history, these islands were the home of millions of happy birds; the resort of a hundred times more millions of fishes, sea lions, and other creatures. Here lived innumerable creatures predestined from the creation of the world to lay up a store of wealth for the British farmer, and a store of quite another sort for an immaculate Republican government.

Source:

"In ages which have no record these islands were the home of millions of happy birds, the resort of a hundred times more millions of fishes, of sea lions, and other creatures whose names are not so common; the marine residence, in fact, of innumerable creatures predestined from the creation of the world to lay up a store of wealth for the British farmer, and a store of quite another sort for an immaculate Republican government."¹

¹A.J. Duffield, *The Prospects of Peru* (London: Newman, 1881) 78.

1: Writer A has included a verbatim passage from his/her source and has failed to indicate it's a direct quotation.

2: Writer A has included a second word for word passage from his/her source without any indication that it is a direct quotation.

Example 4. Mosaic Plagiarism

Student Writer B:

Only two years later, all these friendly Sioux were suddenly plunged into new conditions, including starvation, martial law on all their reservations, and constant urging by their friends and relations to join in warfare against the treacherous government that had kept faith with neither friend nor foe.

Source:

"Contrast the condition into which all these friendly Indians are suddenly plunged now, with their condition only two years previous: martial law now in force on all their reservations; themselves in danger of starvation, and constantly exposed to the influence of emissaries from their friends and relations, urging them to join in fighting this treacherous government that had kept faith with nobody--neither with friend nor with foe."¹

¹Helen Hunt Jackson, *A Century of Dishonor, a Sketch of the United States Government's Dealings with Some of the Indian Tribes* (New York: Harper, 1881) 178.

1: Writer B has borrowed with slight variations an uncited phrase from his/her source. As it's written, the passage would not constitute a paraphrase (even if Writer B had acknowledged his/her source) because it contains keywords from the original source that do not appear in quotation marks.

2: Writer B has borrowed an unacknowledged key word from his/her source, and has not indicated the omission of words with an ellipsis.

3: Writer B has borrowed an unacknowledged phrase from Jackson and has not indicated with brackets that words have been added to the original.

4: Writer B has borrowed an unacknowledged phrase from Jackson without indicating changes he/she has made, including the omission of material and changes in grammar and word choice.

Techniques to Avoid Plagiarism

- ❑ Record relevant documentation information (i.e. author, page number, etc.) in your notes accurately and completely.
- ❑ Indicate in your notes which *ideas (emphasis)* are taken from sources and which are your own thoughts or insights. Be sure to keep this distinction clear in your paper.
- ❑ Put all words borrowed from sources inside quotation marks. In your notes, you might want to circle the quotation marks so you'll be sure to include them in your paper.
- ❑ When paraphrasing or summarizing information from a source, use different words and sentence structures than the original text. Remember - a citation is still required!

Writing Tips:

1. Reread your source until you understand it.
 2. Write your paraphrase or summary without looking at the original text, using your own words and phrasing.
 3. Next, check your version with the original.
 4. Make corrections for clarity, accuracy, and mistakenly borrowed phrases.
- * Remember to provide citations to paraphrased (as well as directly quoted) materials!*

How to evaluate an academic source

- ☐ **Authority:** Who created the resource? Is the author, publisher, and/or producer reputable?
- ☐ **Accuracy:** Is the information reliable? Can factual information be verified in another source?
- ☐ **Purpose:** Can you detect any bias in the content or presentation of the information? What is the purpose of the publication? Is it informative or persuasive?
- ☐ **Scope:** Is the coverage of the topic appropriate for your needs?
- ☐ **Currency:** Does currency matter for your topic? Can you find / verify the date of the material?